SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

21 October 2024 · Shift 2

74 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 16 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 12 questions

Q.3

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 3% per year rate of interest for 6 years.

(A) 670
(B) 570
(C) 630
(D) 590

Q.4

Raghav covers a distance of 45 km in 1 hour 40 minutes. Assuming he maintains a constant speed throughout his journey, what is Raghav's speed (in m/s)?

(A) 6
(B) 7.2
(C) 7.5
(D) 9

Q.7

A sum of money amounts to ₹7,436 after 6 years and ₹9,460 after 10 years at the same rate of simple interest. Find the rate of interest per annum.

(A) 12.5%
(B) 13%
(C) 11.5%
(D) 12%

Q.9

A shopkeeper buys 15 mobiles and sells 12 mobiles at the cost price of 15 mobiles. If the shopkeeper sells all the mobiles at the same price at which he sold the 12 mobiles in the first case, what is the profit percentage?

(A) 25%
(B) 22.5%
(C) 27.5%
(D) 20%

Q.12

Find the arithmetic mean of 5, 15, 25, 26, and 27.

(A) 17.6
(B) 20.6
(C) 18.6
(D) 19.6

Q.13

The average of nine consecutive numbers is 45. The largest number among these numbers is:

(A) 41
(B) 50
(C) 48
(D) 49

Q.14

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 5% per year rate of interest for 6 years.

(A) 690
(B) 710
(C) 790
(D) 750

Q.15

Distance between A and B is 1200 km. If they start moving towards each other at same time, they will meet in 24 hrs. If A starts 10 hrs after B, then they will meet after another 20 hrs. What are their respective speeds?

(A) 25 km/h, 35 km/h
(B) 30 km/h, 20 km/h
(C) 35 km/h, 25 km/h
(D) 40 km/h, 25km/h

Q.16

A can contains a mixture of two liquids, grape juice and pineapple juice in the ratio 13 : 11. When 8 litres of the mixture is drawn off, and the can is filled with pineapple juice, the ratio becomes 13 : 14. How many litres of pineapple juice was initially contained in the can?

(A) 11 litres
(B) 28 litres
(C) 33 litres
(D) 14 litres

Q.17

If the average of 53 consecutive even numbers is 1280. Find the difference between the smallest and the largest number.

(A) 24
(B) 104
(C) 34
(D) 124

Q.18

Find the volume of the largest right circular cone which is inscribed in a hollow cube of length 6 units and is standing on its base.

(A) 18π units^3
(B) 10π units^3
(C) 9π units^3
(D) 21π units^3

Q.19

Find the HCF of 576,324 and 360

(A) 108
(B) 144
(C) 72
(D) 36

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 14 questions

Q.1

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/ subtracting /multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 18, 29; 49, 60

(A) 84, 95
(B) 92, 123
(C) 88, 79
(D) 86, 99

Q.2

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 6, 12, ?, 144, 720 ,4320, 30240

(A) 40
(B) 36
(C) 38
(D) 42

Q.3

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some horses are goats. All goats are jackals. Conclusions: (I): Some horses are jackals. (II): All jackals are goats.

(A) Only conclusion (II) follows.
(B) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows.
(C) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow.
(D) Only conclusion (I) follows.

Q.4

GNJF is related to IPLH in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, KRNJ is related to MTPL. To which of the following is OVRN related, following the same logic?

(A) XQTP
(B) XQPT
(C) QXPT
(D) QXTP

Q.6

In a certain code language, 'BLUE' is coded as '5193' and 'CABS' is coded as '3246'.What is the code for 'B' in the given code language?

(A) 6
(B) 5
(C) 3
(D) 4

Q.8

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All kites are eagles. All eagles are birds. Conclusions: (I) All birds are kites. (II) Some birds are eagles.

(A) Only conclusion (I) follows
(B) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(C) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(D) Only conclusion (II) follows

Q.9

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? MSN, LRM, KQL, JPK, ?

(A) JOI
(B) IJO
(C) JIO
(D) IOJ

Q.10

In a certain code language, 'MILK' is coded as '5642' and 'LIKE' is coded as '8425'. What is the code for 'E' in that language?

(A) 8
(B) 6
(C) 5
(D) 4

Q.11

Five friends, Ashish, Bipin, Chandu, Dinesh and Emmanuel, went on a trek. On the mountain top, they lit a campfire and sat around it in a circle facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). It was recalled that there was only one person sitting between Ashish and Chandu, while Chandu himself was sitting second to the left of Bipin. If Dinesh was an immediate neighbour of both Chandu and Bipin, who was sitting to the immediate right of Ashish?

(A) Dinesh
(B) Emmanuel
(C) Chandu
(D) Bipin

Q.13

4 is related to 41 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 9 is related to 91. To which of the following is 13 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 129
(B) 131
(C) 127
(D) 130

Q.16

ZMJI is related to UIGG in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, TIMN is related to OEJL. To which of the following is PHJI related, following the same logic?

(A) KGDF
(B) GKHF
(C) KDGG
(D) KJED

Q.17

A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Only three people sit between E and F when counted from the left of E. Only three people sit between G and D when counted from the right of D. A sits to the immediate right of G. C is an immediate neighbour of D as well as F. Who sits second to the left of B?

(A) C
(B) G
(C) A
(D) E

Q.18

In a certain code language, 'SOAP' is coded as '4729' and 'POSE' is coded as '9257'. What is the code for 'E' in that language?

(A) 7
(B) 2
(C) 5
(D) 9

Q.20

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? (8÷ 2)× 11 –9× 3 + (51÷ 17) × 6 = 30 (Note: Interchange should be done of the entire number and not individual digits of a given number.)

(A) 9 and 11
(B) 3 and 6
(C) 9 and 6
(D) 11 and 6

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

The elements in Group 17 of the periodic table are known as:

(A) halogens
(B) transition metals
(C) noble gases
(D) alkali metals

Q.2

How many other members are there in the Finance Commission EXCEPT, Chairman?

(A) 6
(B) 3
(C) 5
(D) 4

Q.3

'The Best Mistakes of My Life' is an autobiography of which Indian Actor?

(A) Shahrukh Khan
(B) Dilip Kumar
(C) Salman Khan
(D) Sanjay Khan

Q.4

Who among the following are the target beneficiaries for the 'Vishwakarma Yojana' launched by Government of India on 17 September 2023?

(A) Individuals skilled in traditional craftsmanship
(B) Individuals skilled in traditional folk dance
(C) Individuals skilled in traditional folklore
(D) Individuals skilled in traditional folk songs

Q.5

A tunnel that runs through the cell wall between two plant cells is known as:

(A) plasmodesmata
(B) protoplasm
(C) peroxisome
(D) ribosome

Q.6

As per Census 2011, which of the following union territories has the highest percentage of rural population?

(A) Daman and Diu
(B) Delhi
(C) Puducherry
(D) Chandigarh

Q.7

The process by which a water body gradually becomes enriched with nutrients and minerals, mainly phosphorus and nitrogen, leading to enormous growth of algae on the surface of the water, thus decreasing the amount of dissolved oxygen in the water is known as:

(A) Hypoxia
(B) Biomagnification
(C) Eutrophication
(D) Bioaccumulation

Q.8

Who among the following married the Mughal emperor Jahangir in 1611 and received the title 'Nur Jahan'?

(A) Mumtaz Mahal
(B) Hasina Begum Sahiba
(C) Jahanara Begum
(D) Mehrunnisa

Q.9

During the Mauryan society, Megasthenes divided the Indian society into seven distinct groups. In which distinct group were the 'king's counsellors' placed?

(A) First
(B) Second
(C) Fifth
(D) Seventh

Q.10

Thetakudi Harihara Vinayakram, who became the first Carnatic musician to win a Grammy, is known for playing which musical instrument?

(A) Shehnai
(B) Kanjira
(C) Ghatam
(D) Mridangam

Q.11
Which of the following banking institutions played an instrumental role in financial inclusion through microfinance loans and their expansion in India?

(A) Reserve Bank of India
(B) State Bank of India
(C) Central Bank of India
(D) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development

Q.12
Which of the following is not a tributary of Godavari River?

(A) Kameng
(B) Manjra
(C) Indravati
(D) Pranhita

Q.13
Deodhar Trophy is given in _____.

(A) tennis
(B) hockey
(C) football
(D) cricket

Q.14
Which state topped the medal tally at the 37th National Games event held in Goa?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Haryana
(C) Kerala
(D) Punjab

Q.15
What solution should be used to test for the presence of starch in food?

(A) Magnesium solution
(B) Talc solution
(C) Iodine solution
(D) Ethylene glycol – water solution

Q.16
According to Article 51A of the Indian Constitution, it is the fundamental duty of every person to uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity and _____.

(A) diversity of India
(B) spirituality of India
(C) harmony of India
(D) integrity of India

Q.17
Who introduced ‘Objective Resolution’ in the Constituent Assembly?

(A) BR Ambedkar
(B) Rajendra Prasad
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Vallabhbhai Patel

Q.18
Which of the following ministries has launched the National Career Service Portal (www.ncs.gov.in) ?

(A) Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
(B) Ministry of Labour and Employment
(C) Ministry of Education
(D) Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions

Q.19
The Buland Darwaza was the structure built by Akbar at which of the following places in India?

(A) Lahore
(B) Agra
(C) Fatehpur Sikri
(D) Delhi

Q.20
Bhangra and Giddha dance forms are associated with which Indian state?

(A) Odisha
(B) Punjab
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Gujarat

Q.21
Which of the following options contains groups of cropping seasons in India?

(A) Rabi, Kharif and Zaid
(B) Rabi, Podu and Zaid
(C) Rabi, Kharif and Jhum
(D) Ray, Kharif and Zaid

Q.22
Who among the following led the Indian delegation to attend the 56thAnnual General Meeting of the Board of Governors of Asian Development Bank (ADB) along with Investor/ Bilateral and other associated meetings, in Incheon, the Republic of Korea, from 2 to 5 May 2023?

(A) Nirmala Sitharaman
(B) Meenakshi Lekhi
(C) Renuka Singh Saruta
(D) Smriti Irani

Q.23
On which of the following days is National Integration Day observed?

(A) 26 January
(B) 15 August
(C) 19 November
(D) 2 October

Q.24
Raja and Radha Reddy were awarded the Padma Bhushan in 2000 for giving a new dimension to which dance form?

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Odissi
(C) Manipuri
(D) Sattriya

Q.25
Who among the following freedom fighters was associated with the series of nine articles known as ‘New Lamp for Old’?

(A) Aurobindo Ghose
(B) Bhagat Singh
(C) Sardar Ajit Singh
(D) Swami Vivekananda

English Language and Comprehension 23 questions

Q.2
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Jurisdiction

(A) Expression
(B) Violation
(C) Descent
(D) Governance

Q.3
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who travels from place to place, especially for work

(A) Itinerant
(B) Vagrant
(C) Nomad
(D) Pilgrim

Q.4
The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The dancer / performed weird / but the music was / highly enchanting.

(A) The dancer
(B) highly enchanting.
(C) but the music was
(D) performed weird

Q.5

Select the grammatically correct sentence.

(A) If you want to have a sound working knowledge of Japanese, you must read this book.

(B) If you want to have sound working knowledge of the Japanese, you must read this book.

(C) If you want to have a sound working knowledge of the Japanese, you must read this book.

(D) If you want to have an sound working knowledge of Japanese, you must read this book.

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the following sentence. Success demands hard work, “diligence” and perseverance.

(A) Trouble

(B) indolence

(C) Coolness

(D) Effort

Q.7

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains anerror in phrasal verb. Bindu asked Arya to fill out for / her so that she could / take care of / her sick father.

(A) take care of

(B) her so that he could

(C) her sick father

(D) Bindu asked Arya to fill out for

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The restaurant's menu featured a variety of _____ dishes.

(A) delecious

(B) delitious

(C) delicious

(D) delicius

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Head in the clouds

(A) Being punctual and sincere

(B) Being impractical

(C) Working hard

(D) Thinking about the sky and clouds

Q.10

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) perseverance

(B) parliment

(C) perceive

(D) pastime

Q.11

Choose the correctly spelt word to fill in the blank meaningfully. His _____ is a brilliant student.

(A) sun

(B) sone

(C) sune

(D) son

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Woodcutting involves the removal of useless trees first, _____ by medium and finest quality timber trees.

(A) compared

(B) adjusted

(C) enacted

(D) followed

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I always prefer a small, cosy cottage _____ a high-rise apartment.

(A) for

(B) from

(C) to

(D) than

Q.15

Change the following sentence into positive degree. Sushma is one of the smartest girls in the class.

(A) Sushma is smarter than any other girls in the class.

(B) Few girls in the class are as smart as Sushma.

(C) No other girl is as smart as Sushma.

(D) Sushma is the smart girl of the class.

Q.16

Select the word that has the same meaning (SYNONYM) as the underlined word in the given sentence. Shylock, the Jewish moneylender, and Antonio, the rich Merchant of Venice “loathed” each other.

(A) admired

(B) latte

(C) abhorred

(D) lathered

Q.17

In the following sentence the underlined part contains an error. Alternatives to the underlined part are given as options. Choose the correct alternative. She is “late” than we expected.

(A) latter

(B) more late

(C) later

(D) latest

Q.18

Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the given sentence. Sarvana failed in the examination last week and is “in extreme depression” these days.

(A) In the red

(B) In the lurch

(C) In cold blood

(D) In the doldrums

Q.19

Select the correctly spelled sentence.

(A) The audiance applauded the musicans performance.

(B) The audiance applauded the musician's perfomance.

(C) The audience applauded the muzicians performance.

(D) The audience applauded the musician's performance.

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of ‘clarify’ in the sentence given below. The last question of the examination paper confused me when it asked to illustrate the Pythagoras’ theorem with the help of examples.

(A) Confused

(B) Illustrate

(C) Help

(D) Last

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We are familiar with the quote, " "If winter comes, can spring be far ___1___?" Winters are depressing, but we bear because we know that it will not ___2___ till perpetuity. Spring ___3___ a new life in us. As the spring begins to set itself, the nights become shorter and the days get longer. Gardens and lawns become colourful, buds ___4___ as flowers, birds chirp and butterflies fly from one flower to another to ___5____ on the sweet nectar. The dullness is taken over by brightness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) behind and far

(B) far behind

(C) behind and below

(D) behind

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We are familiar with the quote, " "If winter comes, can spring be far ___1___?" Winters are depressing, but we bear because we know that it will not ___2___ till perpetuity. Spring ___3___ a new life in us. As the spring begins to set itself, the nights become shorter and the days get longer. Gardens and lawns become colourful, buds ___4___ as flowers, birds chirp and butterflies fly from one flower to another to ___5____ on the sweet nectar. The dullness is taken over by brightness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) hold
(B) last
(C) hold on
(D) rest

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We are familiar with the quote, " "If winter comes, can spring be far ___1___?" Winters are depressing, but we bear because we know that it will not ___2___ till perpetuity. Spring ___3___ a new life in us. As the spring begins to set itself, the nights become shorter and the days get longer. Gardens and lawns become colourful, buds ___4___ as flowers, birds chirp and butterflies fly from one flower to another to ___5____ on the sweet nectar. The dullness is taken over by brightness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) immerse
(B) infuses
(C) inculcate
(D) imbue

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We are familiar with the quote, " "If winter comes, can spring be far ___1___?" Winters are depressing, but we bear because we know that it will not ___2___ till perpetuity. Spring ___3___ a new life in us. As the spring begins to set itself, the nights become shorter and the days get longer. Gardens and lawns become colourful, buds ___4___ as flowers, birds chirp and butterflies fly from one flower to another to ___5____ on the sweet nectar. The dullness is taken over by brightness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) pull out
(B) come out
(C) fall over
(D) take out

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We are familiar with the quote, " "If winter comes, can spring be far ___1___?" Winters are depressing, but we bear because we know that it will not ___2___ till perpetuity. Spring ___3___ a new life in us. As the spring begins to set itself, the nights become shorter and the days get longer. Gardens and lawns become colourful, buds ___4___ as flowers, birds chirp and butterflies fly from one flower to another to ___5____ on the sweet nectar. The dullness is taken over by brightness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) food
(B) gulp
(C) gobble
(D) suck

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(D)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**	

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.3 · Answer (C) 630

SI = 3,500 × 3 × 6/100 = ₹630.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 7.5

45 km in 1 hour 40 minutes is 45,000 m in 6,000 seconds: 45,000/6,000 = 7.5 m/s.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 11.5%

The 4 years from year 6 to year 10 add ₹9,460 – ₹7,436 = ₹2,024 of interest, ₹506 a year. The principal is 7,436 – 6 × 506 = ₹4,400, so the rate is 506/4,400 × 100 = 11.5%.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 25%

12 mobiles sell for the cost of 15, so each sells at 15/12 = 1.25 times its cost price: a profit of 25%.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 19.6

(5 + 15 + 25 + 26 + 27)/5 = 98/5 = 19.6.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 49

The middle (fifth) of nine consecutive numbers equals their average, 45. The largest is four more: 49.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 750

SI = 2,500 × 5 × 6/100 = ₹750.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 30 km/h, 20 km/h

Together they cover 1,200 km in 24 hours, so a + b = 50 km/h. In the second case B travels 30 hours and A 20: 20a + 30b = 1,200, so 20 × 50 + 10b = 1,200, b = 20 and a = 30 km/h.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 33 litres

Let the can hold 13k litres of grape and 11k of pineapple juice. Drawing off 8 litres removes 13/3 of grape and 11/3 of pineapple, and 8 litres of pineapple go back in: (13k – 13/3) : (11k – 11/3 + 8) = 13 : 14 gives 39k = 117, so k = 3 and there were 11 × 3 = 33 litres of pineapple juice.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 104

53 consecutive even numbers span 52 steps of 2, so the largest is 52 × 2 = 104 more than the smallest.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 18π units³

The largest cone in a cube of side 6 has base radius 3 and height 6: $V = (1/3)\pi \times 3^2 \times 6 = 18\pi$ units³.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 36

$576 = 2^6 \times 3^2$, $324 = 2^2 \times 3^4$ and $360 = 2^3 \times 3^2 \times 5$. The HCF takes each common prime to its lowest power: $2^2 \times 3^2 = 36$.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (A) 84, 95

In each pair the second number is the first plus 11: 18 + 11 = 29 and 49 + 11 = 60. Likewise 84 + 11 = 95.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 36

Each term is the one before multiplied by 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7 in turn: 6 × 2 = 12, 12 × 3 = 36, 36 × 4 = 144.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Only conclusion (I) follows.

The horses that are goats are also jackals, so some horses are jackals (I). All goats being jackals does not make all jackals goats, so II does not follow.

Q.4 · Answer (D) QXTP

Each letter moves 2 places forward: GNJF → IPLH and KRNJ → MTPL. So OVRN → QXTP.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 3

B is the only letter in both words and 3 the only digit in both codes, so B = 3.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Only conclusion (II) follows
Every eagle is a bird, so some birds are eagles (II). Nothing makes every bird a kite, so I does not follow.

Q.9 · Answer (D) IOJ
Each letter moves one place back each time: M, L, K, J, I; S, R, Q, P, O; N, M, L, K, J. The next cluster is IOJ.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 8
I, L and K are in both words, as are 2, 4 and 5 in both codes. The letter left in LIKE is E and the digit left in its code is 8, so E = 8.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Emmanuel
Facing the centre, a person's left is clockwise. Clockwise from Bipin: Bipin, Dinesh, Chandu (second to Bipin's left, with Dinesh beside both), Emmanuel, Ashish (one person between Ashish and Chandu). Ashish's immediate right, anticlockwise, is Emmanuel.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 131
Each number is multiplied by 10 and 1 added: $4 \times 10 + 1 = 41$ and $9 \times 10 + 1 = 91$. So $13 \times 10 + 1 = 131$.

Q.16 · Answer (C) KDGG
The letters move back 5, 4, 3 and 2 places: ZMJI → UIGG and TIMN → OEJL. So PHJI → KDGG.

Q.17 · Answer (A) C
Facing the centre, left is clockwise. Clockwise the order is E, A, G, B, F, C, D: three people between E and F counting from E's left, three between D and G counting from D's right, A to G's immediate right and C between D and F. Second to the left of B is C.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 5
S, O and P are in both words, as are 2, 7 and 9 in both codes. The letter left in POSE is E and the digit left in its code is 5, so E = 5.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 11 and 6
As printed the left side is $4 \times 11 - 27 + 3 \times 6 = 35$. Interchanging 11 and 6: $4 \times 6 - 27 + 3 \times 11 = 24 - 27 + 33 = 30$.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) halogens
Group 17 (fluorine, chlorine, bromine, iodine and astatine) are the halogens, the 'salt-formers'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 4
Under Article 280 the Finance Commission has a Chairman and four other members, appointed by the President.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Sanjay Khan
'The Best Mistakes of My Life' (2018) is the autobiography of the actor Sanjay Khan.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Individuals skilled in traditional craftsmanship
PM Vishwakarma supports artisans and craftspeople who work with their hands and tools in 18 traditional trades, such as carpenters, potters and blacksmiths.

Q.5 · Answer (A) plasmodesmata
Plasmodesmata are channels through plant cell walls that link the cytoplasm of neighbouring cells.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Puducherry
In the 2011 Census about 32% of Puducherry's people lived in rural areas, against about 25% in Daman and Diu and under 3% in Delhi and Chandigarh.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Eutrophication
Eutrophication is the over-enrichment of water with nutrients such as nitrates and phosphates; the algal blooms it causes use up the dissolved oxygen.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Mehrunnisa
Mehrunnisa married Jahangir in 1611; he called her Nur Mahal and later Nur Jahan, 'light of the world'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Seventh
Megasthenes listed seven classes: philosophers, farmers, herdsmen, artisans, soldiers, overseers and, seventh, the councillors and assessors who advised the king.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Ghatam
Vikku Vinayakram plays the ghatam, a clay-pot percussion instrument; he shared the 1992 Grammy for Mickey Hart's album 'Planet Drum'.

Q.11 · Answer (D) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
NABARD launched the SHG-Bank Linkage Programme in 1992, the main channel of microfinance in India.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Kameng
The Kameng is a tributary of the Brahmaputra, flowing from Arunachal Pradesh into Assam. The Manjra, Indravati and Pranhita all join the Godavari.

Q.13 · Answer (D) cricket
The Deodhar Trophy is an Indian domestic one-day cricket competition.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Maharashtra
Maharashtra topped the medal table at the 37th National Games, held in Goa in 2023.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Iodine solution
Iodine solution turns blue-black when starch is present.

Q.16 · Answer (D) integrity of India
Article 51A(c) makes it a fundamental duty to uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Jawaharlal Nehru
Jawaharlal Nehru moved the Objectives Resolution in the Constituent Assembly on 13 December 1946; it was adopted on 22 January 1947.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Ministry of Labour and Employment
The National Career Service portal was launched in 2015 by the Ministry of Labour and Employment.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Fatehpur Sikri
Akbar built the Buland Darwaza at Fatehpur Sikri to mark his conquest of Gujarat.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Punjab
Bhangra (danced mainly by men) and Giddha (by women) are folk dances of Punjab.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Rabi, Kharif and Zaid
India's three cropping seasons are rabi (winter), kharif (monsoon) and zaid (the short summer season between them). Podu and jhum are forms of shifting cultivation.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Nirmala Sitharaman
Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman led India's delegation to the ADB's 56th Annual Meeting in Incheon in May 2023.

Q.23 · Answer (C) 19 November
National Integration Day is observed on 19 November, Indira Gandhi's birth anniversary.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Kuchipudi
Raja and Radha Reddy are leading exponents of Kuchipudi, the classical dance of Andhra Pradesh.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Aurobindo Ghose
Aurobindo Ghose's 'New Lamps for Old' (1893-94), a series of articles in the Bombay paper Indu Prakash, criticised the moderate politics of the Congress.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.2 · Answer (D) Governance
'Jurisdiction' is the official power to make legal decisions and to govern: 'governance' is closest.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Itinerant
An 'itinerant' travels from place to place, especially for work. A 'vagrant' has no settled home or job, a 'nomad' belongs to a wandering community and a 'pilgrim' journeys to a holy place.

Q.4 · Answer (D) performed weird
A verb is modified by an adverb: 'performed weirdly', not 'performed weird'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) If you want to have a sound working knowledge of Japanese, you must read this book.
A language takes no article ('knowledge of Japanese'; 'the Japanese' are the people), and 'sound' takes 'a', not 'an': 'a sound working knowledge of Japanese'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Effort
'Diligence' is careful, persistent work: 'effort'. 'Indolence' (laziness) is its opposite.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Bindu asked Arya to fill out for
To 'fill in for' someone is to do their work in their place; 'fill out' means to complete a form: 'Bindu asked Arya to fill in for her'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) delicious
The correct spelling is 'delicious'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Being impractical
Someone with their 'head in the clouds' is a daydreamer, out of touch with practical matters.

Q.10 · Answer (B) parliment
The correct spelling is 'parliament'.

Q.11 · Answer (D) son
'Son', a male child, fits the sentence; 'sun' sounds the same but means the star.

Q.12 · Answer (D) followed
The medium and finest quality trees are removed after the useless ones: 'first, followed by'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) to
'Prefer' takes 'to' before the thing not chosen: 'prefer a small, cosy cottage to a high-rise apartment'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Few girls in the class are as smart as Sushma.
'One of the smartest' puts Sushma among a few at the top; in the positive degree that is 'Few girls in the class are as smart as Sushma'. 'No other girl is as smart' would make her the smartest.

Q.16 · Answer (C) abhorred
'Loathed' means hated intensely: 'abhorred'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) later
'Than' needs the comparative: 'She is later than we expected.'

Q.18 · Answer (D) In the doldrums
To be 'in the doldrums' is to be low in spirits. 'In the red' is in debt, 'in the lurch' left in difficulty and 'in cold blood' without pity.

Q.19 · Answer (D) The audience applauded the musician's performance.
The correct spellings are 'audience', 'musician's' and 'performance'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Illustrate
To 'illustrate' is to make clear, especially with examples: the sentence's word closest to 'clarify'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) behind
'If Winter comes, can Spring be far behind?' is the closing line of Shelley's 'Ode to the West Wind'.

Q.22 · Answer (B) last
Winter will not 'last' till perpetuity, that is for ever.

Q.23 · Answer (B) infuses
To 'infuse' is to fill with a quality, and of the verbs only 'infuses' agrees with the singular 'Spring': 'Spring infuses a new life in us'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) come out
Buds 'come out' as flowers: they open and bloom.

Q.25 · Answer (D) suck
Butterflies 'suck' nectar from flowers; 'gulp' and 'gobble' mean swallowing food quickly.

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